

PROSPER AWUNI

Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender, Incident Response, Vulnerability Management | CISSP

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am an experienced Cyber Security Engineer and Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience taking ownership of cybersecurity controls and security architecture in enterprise environments. I specialise in Microsoft Sentinel (Security Information and Event Management), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Identity and Microsoft 365, Incident Response, Threat Monitoring, and Vulnerability Management. At the University of the Arts London, I led the design and delivery of cybersecurity engineering across a complex, global-scale IT environment, working closely with infrastructure teams to identify vulnerabilities, respond to incidents, and continuously strengthen the organisation's overall security posture. I have strong experience implementing Single Sign-On (SSO), Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Public Key Infrastructure (PKI) and identity controls through Entra ID and Azure Active Directory (AD). I am a technically hands-on engineer who thrives in collaborative, cross-functional settings and is committed to aligning security practice with regulatory frameworks including ISO 27001 and the NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF).

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Threat Monitoring:** Microsoft Sentinel, KQL (Kusto Query Language) detection rule development, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR), alert triage, incident investigation
- **Endpoint and Identity Security:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Microsoft 365 (M365), CrowdStrike Falcon EDR (Endpoint Detection and Response)
- **Security Architecture and Engineering:** Cybersecurity controls design, SSO, MFA, PKI (Public Key Infrastructure), Conditional Access, Zero Trust principles
- **Identity and Access Management:** Entra ID / Azure Active Directory, Conditional Access, BeyondTrust PAM (Privileged Access Management), least-privilege enforcement
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera BAS (Breach and Attack Simulation), Nessus, AppCheck; penetration test finding remediation
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 Incident Response lifecycle, MITRE ATT&CK Framework, threat hunting, digital forensics triage
- **Endpoint and Device Management:** Microsoft Intune / MDM (Mobile Device Management), MAM (Mobile Application Management), Tanium
- **Email and Network Security:** Mimecast, Check Point Harmony Firewall, WAF (Web Application Firewall), IDS (Intrusion Detection System) / IPS (Intrusion Prevention System)
- **Frameworks and Compliance:** ISO 27001, NIST CSF, CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, SOAR playbooks

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Took ownership of cybersecurity controls and security architecture across a global IT environment, reporting to senior technology leadership and working closely with infrastructure operations teams
- Administered and tuned Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, developing KQL-based detection rules, building SOAR playbooks and leading threat monitoring activities across the organisation
- Managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI) and Defender for Microsoft 365 across an 8,000-user estate, significantly improving threat visibility and response capability

- Identified vulnerabilities through Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Nessus and AppCheck; coordinated remediation with infrastructure teams and tracked findings to closure
- Led incident response activities in line with NIST 800-61 and the MITRE ATT&CK Framework, covering detection, containment, eradication and recovery; produced post-incident reports for senior stakeholders
- Designed and implemented SSO, MFA, Conditional Access and PKI controls via Entra ID and Azure Active Directory, strengthening identity security across the institution
- Administered BeyondTrust PAM (Privileged Access Management) to enforce least-privilege access and secure administrative credentials
- Managed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Mimecast email security gateway, Check Point Harmony Firewall and Intune MDM as part of a comprehensive, layered security architecture

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Monitored and investigated security alerts via Microsoft Sentinel SIEM and CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, performing threat monitoring, triage and incident escalation
- Supported cybersecurity controls implementation including MFA, SSO, Conditional Access and identity governance through Entra ID and Azure AD
- Conducted vulnerability scans using Tenable.io and Nessus; maintained a vulnerability register and worked with infrastructure teams on remediation
- Contributed to incident response investigations, applying MITRE ATT&CK mapping to identify attacker tactics, techniques and procedures
- Managed Mimecast email gateway configurations including anti-phishing, URL filtering and data loss prevention policies
- Supported Cyber Essentials Plus certification and maintained alignment with ISO 27001 and NIST CSF requirements

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Managed security controls and infrastructure in a SaaS and FinTech environment, including endpoint protection, access management and vulnerability assessments
- Supported incident response activities, firewall management and security monitoring; contributed to compliance and quality assurance documentation

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed and managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Identity and M365 across 8,000 users at UAL, delivering full-coverage threat monitoring and measurable improvements to incident detection speed
- Built and tuned Microsoft Sentinel SIEM detection rules using KQL, reducing false positive rates and improving analyst efficiency in threat monitoring
- Designed and implemented SSO and MFA controls via Entra ID for 8,000 users, significantly reducing identity-based attack risk
- Achieved Cyber Essentials Plus certification for UAL, demonstrating alignment of cybersecurity controls with recognised industry standards
- Led the full incident response lifecycle for multiple high-severity incidents at UAL, containing and remediating threats with minimal business disruption
- Developed SOAR automated playbooks for Sentinel, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for common alert types by automating initial triage and containment steps

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security Plus (Security+)
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)

- CompTIA A Plus (A+)
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)